

Hackles Club: Homeschool Co-op Edition (12-Week Plan, Mixed Ages)

The Hackles Kit

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

FIELD COPY

1



Lock It

PASSWORDS AND ACCOUNTS

2



Spot It

SCAMS AND FAKES

3



Share Smart

PRIVACY

4



Safe People

WHO TO TRUST

5



Kind and Well

KINDNESS AND BALANCE

6



Fix It

TELL, REPAIR, RECOVER

PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

A free kit by **Competence Collective** · competencecollective.org

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials: CC BY-NC 4.0 (free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit). The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]



OCTOBER 2026

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials CC BY-NC 4.0. The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]

[Logo: Hackles]

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org

Status: DRAFT. [VERIFY] and [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM] flags must be cleared before publication. Read 00_Start_Here_Club_Leaders.md first, especially Sections 5, 6 and 7.

No child accounts, no child data collected, ever.

01 At a glance

SPECIMEN LABEL	
WHO	A homeschool co-op or learning pod with mixed ages from 5 to 15, 6 to 25 children
TIME	12 weekly sessions of 60 to 75 minutes, plus optional reading and writing at home
LEADERS	A co-op parent leads each week. Two adults are present at every session (Start Here, Section 5). A rotating "co-leader" parent keeps the second pair of eyes.
DEVICES	None
BUDGET	Under \$10 for the term (see Section 2)
CARDS	Sets A, B and C (01_Club_Card_Sets.md)

HOW A MIXED-AGE ROOM WORKS

- **Buddy pairs.** Pair a younger child (5 to 8) with an older child (10 to 15). The older child reads the card aloud (or the adult does), and the younger child gives the first answer. Rotate partners every few weeks.
- **Three levels of every activity.** Every week lists a **Little** (5 to 7), **Middle** (8 to 11) and **Teen** (12 to 15) way to take part. A child can choose any level.
- **Siblings.** Siblings may be in the same group or in different groups. Ask families.
- **A parent is not a "second adult" for their own child's group alone.** Two adults other than any one family's parent must be present in the room unless your co-op's policy says otherwise [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM].
- **Parents who teach.** In a co-op, a parent is both a parent and a leader. When a child says something hard, the leader uses the Start Here card, and a co-op parent whose own child it is does not run the conversation alone.

WEEKLY SHAPE (60 TO 75 MINUTES)

MIN	PART
5	Gather. Two promises. Hackles Chant.
10	Mini-lesson. The leader reads aloud or tells a short story.
20	Game. Played in buddy pairs or teams.
10	Practice. Role-play or Tell sentence.
5	Calm-down or screen break.
15	Read and write. Quiet time with the weekly extension.
5	Close. Take-home activity.

02 **Supply list: under \$10 for the term**

Prices are rough [VERIFY locally]. Assume you own paper, pencils, crayons and a printer.

ITEM	USE	ESTIMATE
Pack of 100 index cards	Cards, passports, scenes	\$2
Masking tape	Trail, Door	\$3
Pack of sticky notes	Plans and notes	\$2
Envelopes (small pack)	Missions	\$2
Total		About \$9

Optional: a shared binder for the term, a bell, a timer.

03 The 12 weeks at a glance

WEEK	THEME	CREW	GAME	READ ALOUD
1	Hackles Up	Hackle	Pause Palm Freeze	Read-Aloud 1
2	The Help Ladder	Buddy	Ladder Climb and Mini Trail	Role-play R3 as a play
3	Passwords and Passphrases	Latch	Passphrase Vault (Quick)	Read-Aloud 2 and 6
4	Spot the Fishy	Peeper	Pond Patrol	Read-Aloud 5
5	Check the Source	Peeper	Snow Day mission (Stages 1 to 3)	A short fake-or-real story from the leader
6	Share Smart	Pip	Share or Shell and Meet Quinn	Read-Aloud 3
7	Kind Clicks	Ember	Four Moves corners	A short upstander story from the leader
8	Screen Balance and Calm	Ember	Family Screen Plan game	A leader-chosen calm story
9	Oops Recovery	Fixit, Rinse	Oops role-plays	Read-Aloud 4 and 8
10	Family Code Word and Family Plan	Buddy	Code Word role-play (adults join)	A short leader story
11	The Quiet Door Mission	All	Full mission in mixed teams	None
12	Hackles Day	All	Stations for families	None

THE READ-ALOUDS ARE FROM the Games and Fun Pack, file 04_Read_Alouds_and_Graphic_Stories.md. Other titles are original to your group or are [librarian to fill].

READING AND WRITING EXTENSIONS (THE PATTERN)

Each week has three extension levels. **None asks a child to write about a real incident, a real person, a real password or a real account.** Invent a character instead.

LEVEL	READING	WRITING
Little (5-7)	Listen to a read-aloud. Retell it with a drawing.	Draw it, then dictate or write one sentence. "Hackle says: _____"
Middle (8-11)	Read a short passage (Games Pack read-alouds 5 to 8, or a library book)	Write a paragraph from a made-up character's point of view. Use a story frame.
Teen (12-15)	Read a case file (a short fictional message and its context)	Write a one-page analysis, a script or a Q and A for a younger child

04 The weekly plans

WEEK 1: HACKLES UP

Goal: Everyone can do the four moves and say the two promises.

Game: Pause Palm Freeze. Music plays, children dance. When it stops, an adult shouts a silly Gifty offer ("FREE PONIES! TAP THE BOX!"). Children freeze, show the Pause Palm, and shout "Hackles up! No thanks, Gifty!" No one is out. Gifty is an adult.

Mini-lesson. Read-Aloud 1, "Hackle's Tuft Pops Up" (Games Pack). Say the routine: Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.

Practice. Buddy pairs say the Tell sentence: "I need help with something online. I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something." The partner says the Good Grown-up Reply.

Calm-down. Ember's Warm Breath: breathe in for 4, out for 6.

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw Hackle with the tuft up, and one grown-up you trust.
- **Middle:** write a paragraph about a made-up kid who feels "hackles up" and what they do.
- **Teen:** write three cues that something online is off, in your own words, and which one is hardest to notice.

At home (5 minutes): Ask your child to teach you the hand signals.

If it goes wrong: A child who cannot name a trusted adult: "Today your co-op leaders count." Tell the co-op's safeguarding contact.

WEEK 2: THE HELP LADDER

Goal: Children know their rungs and the Next-Rung Rule.

Game: Ladder Climb, then Mini Trail. Everyone climbs an invisible ladder (a friend you trust, a trusted adult, a report tool). An adult plays the person who says "Ignore it", and the group shouts "Next rung!" Then play the 15-space Mini Trail with Trail scenes TA, TB and TC (01_Club_Card_Sets.md).

Mini-lesson. Read a short play: Role-play R3, "Rung Two Says Ignore It" (Games Pack file 06), with a puppet.

Practice. Tell-3: need, facts, ask. Teens coach little ones.

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw a ladder with three rungs, and put a person on each.
- **Middle:** write a script for a kid who tells two adults.

- **Teen:** write a short guide, "How to be a good next rung."

At home: Say the Good Grown-up Reply at dinner.

WEEK 3: PASSWORDS AND PASSPHRASES

Goal: Children can say what makes a passphrase strong (long, silly, secret) and who can know it.

Game: Passphrase Vault (Quick). Little: Latch's Silly Vault (Session 2 of Track A). Middle and Teen: Mission E1 Stages 1, 3 and 4 (Track B Session 2).

Mini-lesson. Read-Aloud 2, "Latch and the Silly Words", or Read-Aloud 6, "Mateo's Passphrase Puzzle" (Games Pack). Do the dice demo: hide one die under a cup, then two, then ask about ten (Concepts Lab Demo 01).

Practice. Say "No thanks. My password is only for me and my grown-up."

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw a purple banana, a trumpet and a dinosaur.
- **Middle:** write a four-word silly phrase (practice) and the reasons it is strong.
- **Teen:** write why length beats symbols. Include one example.

At home: Make a silly passphrase for a stuffed animal.

If it goes wrong: A child says a real password. "Please keep that one private. Let's use a pretend one."

WEEK 4: SPOT THE FISHY

Goal: Children use SPOT or FLAGS to find the clues in fishy messages.

Game: Pond Patrol (Track B Session 3). Use Set A for little, B for middle, C for teens, mixed in each round.

Mini-lesson. Read-Aloud 5, "The Treasure That Wasn't" (Games Pack).

Practice. Role-play "Check a Different Way" (R6).

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw a pop-up and circle the "too good" part.
- **Middle:** rewrite a fishy message as a safe one.
- **Teen:** write a one-page "Is it fishy?" checklist in your own words.

At home: Find a pretend scam together.

WEEK 5: CHECK THE SOURCE

Goal: Children know that "it looks real" is weak evidence, and "the official source says so" is strong.

Game: The Snow Day That Wasn't (Mission M3, Stages 1 to 3). Little children are the "Door helpers" (they pull the envelope cards and cheer). Middle and teens solve.

Mini-lesson. The leader tells a short made-up story: a rumor that "school is closed" goes around. Who checks?

Practice. Teens ask: "Who posted this first? What does the official site say?"

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw a "real" and a "fake" snowman, and tell what's different.
- **Middle:** write how to check one rumor.
- **Teen:** write a short note to your family, "How to check before you share."

At home: Check a story together before sharing it.

WEEK 6: SHARE SMART

Goal: Children know what stays in the shell and ask before sharing a photo.

Game: Share or Shell and Meet Quinn (Track A Session 4, Track B Session 4). Quinn is made up. **Never use a real child.**

Mini-lesson. Read-Aloud 3, "Pip Picks a Shell" (Games Pack).

Practice. "Do all my friends say OK?" with buddy pairs.

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw what Pip keeps in the shell.
- **Middle:** write a paragraph on how small facts add up.
- **Teen:** audit a pretend app's permissions (PicNest) and write what you would turn off.

At home: Pick one photo rule for your family.

WEEK 7: KIND CLICKS

Goal: Children know four safe responses to unkindness and that telling is always okay.

Game: Four Moves corners (Say It, Stand With, Keep It, Tell It).

Mini-lesson. The leader reads a short made-up story where a child does not forward a mean picture.

Practice. Role-play "Keep It" (R16) and "Say It" (R13).

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw a "kind click".
- **Middle:** write what you would say and do for one scenario.
- **Teen:** write a "Kind Chat Rules" poster for a group.

At home: Say one kind thing a day.

If it goes wrong: A child says they were picked on. Use the Start Here card.
A co-op parent whose child it is does not handle it alone.

WEEK 8: SCREEN BALANCE AND CALM

Goal: Children can take a screen break and say how they feel.

Game: Family Screen Plan game. Teams draw a "perfect day" with screen-free time. Use no devices. Each child picks one screen-free hour.

Mini-lesson. Ember's Warm Breath, stretching, a 20-second look at something far away.

Practice. Each child names one thing they enjoy that is not on a screen.

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw a favorite screen-free activity.
- **Middle:** write a day plan with breaks.
- **Teen:** write a short reflection on how a feed or a game pulls you in, in general terms, with no personal detail required.

At home: Do the screen-free hour together.

If it goes wrong: A child seems very low or says they cannot stop. Use the Start Here card and tell the co-op's safeguarding contact.

WEEK 9: OOPS RECOVERY

Goal: Children can say "I made an oops, I need help" and know the O.O.P.S. steps.

Game: Oops role-plays (R2, R9, R10). Use puppets for little ones.

Mini-lesson. Read-Aloud 4, "Fixit and the Oops Button", or Read-Aloud 8, "Sam's Whoops Day" (Games Pack).

Practice. Rinse's three questions: What happened? Are we safe? What do we do next?

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw Fixit's toolbelt.
- **Middle:** write a made-up kid's oops and fix.
- **Teen:** write the five Oops Path steps in your own words.

At home: Say the Good Grown-up Reply the next time anyone has an oops.

WEEK 10: FAMILY CODE WORD AND FAMILY PLAN

Goal: Families agree on a code word and a callback rule.

Game: Code Word role-play (R19). Adults join this session.

Mini-lesson. The leader explains the Family Code Word guide in plain language.

Practice. Role-play: "I'll call you back at the number I already have."

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw a "secret word" box. (They do not write the real word.)
- **Middle:** write a plan for what to do if a call says a family member is in trouble.
- **Teen:** write a one-page family guide for the grandparent or an older relative.

At home: Choose a real code word at home. Do not bring it to the co-op.

WEEK 11: THE QUIET DOOR MISSION

Goal: A mixed team solves a mission together and opens the Door.

Game. Mission E2 (Fake Giveaway) or Mission M1 (Account Vault), depending on the group. Use mixed teams with roles: Reader, Recorder, Runner, Door Keeper (an adult). Hint ladder: nudge, bigger nudge, the Door Keeper does the first step.

Reading and writing.

- **Little:** draw the Door.
- **Middle:** write a short report on how the team solved it.
- **Teen:** write a mission debrief: what worked and what to change.

WEEK 12: HACKLES DAY

Goal: The co-op shows its families what it learned.

Format. Follow the Family Night Kit (file 05). Older children host stations. Younger children may hand out cards. No child is required to host.

Awards. Hackles Patch Level 1 or 2 for any child who earned one (file 06), and a Club certificate (file 13).

Reading and writing. Each child writes a one-line "my favorite thing I learned".

05 Discussion questions for any week

1. What was the first thing you noticed?
2. What did you do next?
3. Who is on your Help Ladder?
4. What was hard? What would make it easier?
5. What is one sentence you will remember?

06 Co-op notes

- **Local rules.** Co-ops and homeschool groups are covered by different rules in different places. Check yours [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM].
- **Safeguarding contact.** Name one trusted adult in your co-op who knows the reporting rule. Write it in Start Here, Section 5.
- **No child data.** Do not keep a list of what any child said or wrote. The child keeps their pages.
- **Hard topics.** The co-op does not cover the topics in Start Here, Section 7. If a family wants to, they handle them at home with a counselor's help.